Zetclass User Guide · 3b · Special section · Owner only

Where school data is saved

What is stored, where it lives, how schools are kept apart, and how to back it up.

Who: the Zetclass owner (Zetranova) only **Last updated:** 5 Nov 2026

App version: 20261125

The short answer

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Database	A big organised filing cabinet on the internet. Zetclass uses one called MySQL.
Server	A computer that is always on. Yours is rented from Namecheap.
School id	The short name that labels one school's records, like st-marys.

School data is **not** kept on teachers' phones or computers. It is saved in **one MySQL database on your web hosting account**, and every school's records carry that school's id so they stay apart. Your phone or computer only holds a sign-in pass and the app's own files.

A simple picture

Imagine one large filing room. Every school has its own locked drawer, labelled with its school id. When someone signs in, the receptionist (the API) hands them a pass that names *one* drawer. From then on, the receptionist only ever opens that drawer for them. Nobody can ask for another school's drawer, even by trying.

Where exactly

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

cPanel	The control panel of your hosting, where you manage files and databases.
Config file	A private file with secret settings. It is never put on GitHub.
GitHub	Where the program code is kept. No school data is there.
IndexedDB	Private storage inside a browser. Used for the offline copy.

What	Where it lives
All school records	The MySQL database on your **Namecheap hosting**, in the cPanel account that holds `zetranova.com` (server190). Zetclass shares that account with your other sites.

The Zetclass program files	The folder `/home/zetrekzh/zetclass.com/app` on the same hosting account.
The secret settings	A private file called `config.local.php` inside the `api` folder: database name and password, the app's signing secret, the owner login (scrambled), and mail settings. It is **not** on GitHub.
The code	GitHub (`datatitbit/zetclass`) holds the **code only**. No school data is ever stored there.
On a user's device (offline copy)	The app's own files, and the last school name and user type typed. **While someone is signed in**, the records they have opened are also kept in the browser's private storage (IndexedDB) so the app keeps working offline, together with a queue of changes made offline that have not yet reached the server, and a small batch of reserved ID numbers. Logging out clears all of it. If the person ticked *Keep me signed in on this device*, the sign-in pass is also kept for up to 12 hours.

NOT CONFIRMED

Which country your hosting server physically sits in is not shown in cPanel. To see it: sign in to Namecheap → **Hosting List** → **Manage** next to your plan, and look for the **data center** location. Write it here once known, because schools and the Data Protection Commission may ask.

What is inside the database

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Table One drawer of the filing cabinet, for example the list of schools.
Record One item in a drawer, like one pupil.

Table (drawer)	What it holds
schools	One row per school: name, portal address, plan, trial and paid dates, status, contact details, country/region/district/locality, licence number and Verified mark, your private notes.
documents	The school's day-to-day records, each tagged with the school id: pupils, parents, staff, **login accounts**, classes, attendance, scores, fees and payments, stock, accounts and more.
singletons	One-of-a-kind items per school: the school profile (including its logo, signature and stamp images), academic year and term, grading and report settings, access settings.

meta_seq	Counters that make the next pupil or staff number (e.g. ST0042).
platform_audit	The activity log of everything the owner does, and each signup.
password_resets	One-hour reset links and "Forgot password" requests (the link is stored scrambled).
rate_limits	Counters that slow down guessing (sign-in tries, signups).
app_meta	The database's version number, so updates upgrade it safely.

How schools are kept apart

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Token A signed pass the browser carries after sign-in. It names one school.

API The helper that fetches and saves records. It only opens the school named on your pass.

- Every record carries its **school id**, and every request is filtered by the school id inside the sign-in pass, **never** by anything the browser sends.
- The pass is **signed** with a secret only the server knows, and expires after about 12 hours.
- A school Admin can only touch their own school. The owner's control room is a separate account.
- Tests confirm that one school cannot read or change another's records.

How passwords are stored

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Hash A password scrambled one way. It can be checked but never read back.

Temporary password A one-time password shown once on screen. Zetclass keeps no readable copy.

- Passwords are stored only as **hashes** (PBKDF2, 100,000 rounds, with a random salt). Nobody, including you, can read them back.
- Temporary passwords are shown **once** on screen. Zetclass does not keep a readable copy.
- Staff passwords are scrambled in the person's browser before they are sent.

Who can see school data

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

phpMyAdmin A tool in cPanel that shows the whole database. Protect your hosting sign-in.

Who	What they can reach
A school's users	Only their own school, and only what their user type allows.
The owner (control room)	School details, subscription and account lists. **Log in as this school** shows records, time-limited and written to the activity log.
Anyone with cPanel / phpMyAdmin access	Everything in the database. Protect the hosting login and turn on two-step sign-in for it.

Backups: what you have, and what to do

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Backup	A copy kept somewhere else, so you can recover from a mistake or failure.
Off-server	Kept outside the hosting account, for example on your computer.
OneDrive	Your online folder on your computer. A safe place for backups.
Full account backup	A copy of everything in the hosting account, including the private settings file.

WHAT WE FOUND (CHECKED IN YOUR CPANEL, 5 NOV 2026)

- Namecheap does **not** show you any automatic backups. The Backup page says none are available unless the server owner turns them on, and there is no JetBackup tool.
- You **can** download backups by hand. Your Zetclass database is named `zetrekzh_zetclass` and is tiny (about 1.7 MB), so a backup takes seconds.
- So **your own downloads are your only safety net**. Do not rely on Namecheap having a copy.

Where to keep the copies (you only have Namecheap: that is fine)

A backup must live **somewhere other than the hosting account**, otherwise one problem can lose both. You already have two places, and no new account is needed:

- **Your computer's OneDrive** (the Zetranova Product folder already lives there). Make a folder called `Zetclass Backups`. This is the main place.
- **Your Gmail / Google Drive** (optional second copy). Upload the same file to Google Drive, or email it to yourself.

KEEP THEM PRIVATE

A backup contains every school's pupil, parent and staff information. Keep the folder private: do not share it, and do not send it to anyone.

Take a backup (about 2 minutes, once a week)

1. Sign in to **Namecheap**, open **Hosting List**, and next to your hosting plan choose **Go to cPanel**. [You reach the same cPanel you already use.]
2. In cPanel, under **Files**, open **Backup**.
3. Scroll to **Partial Backups**. Under **Download a Database Backup**, click `zetrekzh_zetclass`.
4. A database file downloads (usually ending in `.sql.gz`). Open your Downloads folder and **rename it with today's date**, e.g. `zetclass-db-2026-11-05.sql.gz`.
5. Move it into the OneDrive folder `Zetclass Backups`.

CHECK

The file is in OneDrive, shows a green tick (synced), and is larger than 0 KB.

Once, and after big changes: also click **Download a Full Account Backup** [top of the same page]. It includes the private settings file (`config.local.php`) that the database backup does not. cPanel prepares it, which can take a few minutes, and tells you when it is ready to download (it may send an email). *(The exact wording on that page was not checked.)*

TIP

Keep the last 8 weekly files, and delete older ones. They are small. Put a repeating reminder on your phone for the same day each week.

Test a restore once

A backup you have never tried is only a hope. Ask your developer or assistant to restore one into a **test** database and check that a school opens. This guide will gain exact restore steps once that has been done.

Also good to know

- **Each school can export its own data.** The school Admin: Settings → Data → **Export data (JSON)**. Encourage schools to do this monthly. It is their own copy, and it does not replace yours.
- The **code** is safe on GitHub, so you do not need to back up the program files, only the database and the private settings file.
- **Optional next step:** an automatic nightly copy kept on the server (using a cPanel scheduled task). It protects against mistakes such as an accidental delete, but **not**

against losing the hosting account, so it adds to your weekly download and does not replace it. Ask your developer or assistant to set it up if you want it.

What happens when a school is deleted or reset

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Delete	Removes the school and all its records for good.
Reset	Removes the records but keeps the school's account and subscription.

- **Delete school permanently** removes the school's row, all its records (*documents*), its settings (*singletons*), its counters and its reset links. The activity log keeps a line that the school was deleted (its name and when), not its pupil records.
- **Reset school data** removes records, settings and counters but keeps the school's row (subscription, contact details).
- Deleted data cannot be recovered except from a backup you took earlier.

Looking ahead

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

PostgreSQL	A bigger kind of database for later, when Zetclass grows.
Dedicated server	A server used only by Zetclass, not shared with other websites.

The plan is to keep the MySQL database on shared hosting for now. As Zetclass grows, the data can move to a larger database (e.g. PostgreSQL) on a dedicated server. When that happens, this page will be updated and the update log below will say so.

Checklist for the owner

WORDS IN THIS SECTION

Two-step sign-in	A second code, sent to your phone, needed to sign in. It stops strangers.
Data Protection Commission	The Ghana office that registers organisations holding people's information.

- ☐ Keep the cPanel and control-room passwords private; turn on two-step sign-in for hosting.
- ☐ Download the database backup every week and keep it in OneDrive (and optionally Google Drive).
- ☐ Remember: Namecheap shows you no automatic backups, so your downloads are the only copy.

- ☐ Register with the Ghana Data Protection Commission and keep the Privacy Notice up to date.
- ☐ Delete your own test schools after trying signup.

Update log

Date	App version	What changed
5 Nov 2026	20261118	First edition. Covers the database, files, separation between schools, passwords, access, backups and deletion.
5 Nov 2026	20261118	Backups section rewritten for Namecheap-only hosting: verified that no automatic backups are available; added exact download steps and where to keep copies (OneDrive, Google Drive).
5 Nov 2026	20261125	Added the offline copy kept on a signed-in device, the queue of unsynced changes, and reserved ID-number batches.